Follow-up of Incidental and Known Pulmonary Nodules

Reference	RAD-FUP-02 v2
Owner	Thoracic Imaging Lead
Approved by	Quality and Patient Safety Committee
Effective date	15/06/2026
Next review	15/06/2029
Applies to	All clinical areas of the Centre Hospitalier Saint-Aubin

1. Measurement

Nodules are measured as the longest axial diameter in millimetres on lung windows. Change is expressed as the percentage change in longest diameter between the two most recent examinations.

2. Action by size and change

Finding	Action
Solid nodule under 6 mm, no risk factor	no follow-up
Known nodule, increase in longest diameter under 20%	repeat CT 12 months after the latest examination
Known nodule, increase in longest diameter of 20% or more	refer to the thoracic multidisciplinary team (MDT) within 14 days of the report date; PET-CT before the MDT
New solid nodule of 8 mm or more	refer to the thoracic MDT within 14 days of the report date

3. Governance, audit and training

This document is controlled. Printed copies are uncontrolled: the current version is held on the hospital document management system and a printed copy must be checked against it before use.

The document owner reviews the content at least every three years or earlier when national guidance, a serious incident or an audit finding requires it. Interim changes are approved by the relevant committee chair and recorded in the revision history.

Compliance is audited by the clinical audit department on a rolling sample of records. Results are reported to the quality and patient safety committee, which agrees actions with the ward managers and monitors their completion.

Staff who identify a deviation from this document, or a situation it does not cover, should discuss it with the senior clinician on duty and report it through the incident reporting system. Reporting is a learning tool and not a disciplinary process.

4. Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
1.0	15/06/2021	Thoracic Imaging Lead	First issue
2.0	15/06/2023	Thoracic Imaging Lead	Triennial review; format harmonised
3.0	15/06/2025	Thoracic Imaging Lead	Tables updated after clinical audit
current	15/06/2026	Thoracic Imaging Lead	Review and re-issue

Annex A. Implementation notes

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Training on this document is part of the induction programme for clinical staff and is refreshed through the annual mandatory training cycle. Agency and locum staff receive a short briefing at the start of their first shift.

Data protection: any patient information handled under this document is processed in accordance with the data protection policy of the hospital. Access to records is limited to staff involved in the care of the patient.

Equality and diversity: this document has been assessed for its effect on patients and staff with protected characteristics. Reasonable adjustments, interpreters and accessible formats are available through the patient experience team.

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Where this document refers to a role (for example the ward pharmacist or the senior nurse), the post-holder on duty carries out the task or delegates it to a suitably trained colleague who remains accountable to them.

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